



Testing With Customer Interviews

Interview Questions Cheat Sheet

Your interview questions must always relate to one or several hypotheses underlying your Value Proposition Canvas. To help you get started, we compiled a list of questions on fundamental aspects of the Value Proposition Canvas to explore with customers.

Note: You will not be able to cover these six topics in one interview, and you're not expected to do so. Instead, start by focusing on elements relating to the Customer Profile and expand to questions related to the Value Map once you have a fairly good understanding of your customers.

Customer Profile Questions

1. Customer Segmentation

These are questions helping you better understand the demographics that characterize your interviewee.

- Who are you?
- What do you do?
- What handles the process of (job-to-be-done) at home/office?
- How involved are you in the process of (job-to-be-done)?

2. Your Customer's Jobs, Pains & Gains

As mentioned above, you must test the hypotheses related to your customer's jobs, pains and gains first. With the help of these questions, you'll learn about what matters the most to your customers. However, this can only happen if you let yourself get immersed into their world and don't keep your solution in mind.

- What are your most significant problems? What happens when they occur?
- What are your personal/professional goals?
- What's the hardest part of your day?
- What is the most frustrating thing about (your task, your role, your day, etc.)?
- What's the hardest thing when doing (activity related to fulfilling a job)?
- What are your current challenges at work/home? At work/home, what tasks are creating serious headaches?
- When was the last time this happened? Can you tell me what happened in more details? How often does this happen?
- What do these hurdles block you from achieving? Describe me what a day would look like if these hurdles suddenly vanished?
- Can give me a specific description of what success looks like for you? for your customers?

- How have you tried to achieve these goals so far? Can you give me an example?
- What are you trying to achieve by doing (activity related to fulfilling a job)?
- What could improve the process of (job-to-be-done)? Can you describe to me how this would work?
- What would make your life easier at work/home?

3. The Intensity Of Your Customer's Jobs, Pains & Gains

Uncovering jobs, pains and gains is an excellent first step, but not all jobs, pains or gains are important to your customer. In your interview, you need to identify which ones matter the most to them and which ones are trivial.

- Can you rank the issues you mentioned before with the most critical ones at the top?
- On a scale of 1 (not important) to 10 (very important), how much would this problem score?
- What's a 10/10 problem?
- How much time per week are you willing to spend to find a solution for (problem/process) or fix it?
- What's the maximum that you would pay if someone or something could instantly dissolve this pain/problem?
- If you could solve only one problem at work/home, which one would you focus on?

Value Map Questions

4. How Existing Solution Create Value And Where They Fall Short

Learnings on existing solutions that solve the same jobs, pains and gains that your value proposition targets gives you an edge as you can work on designing a superior alternative. Explore existing solutions with customers and learn about what customers love or hate about them.

- Do you use outside services or products to solve (job-to-be-done)?
- Under what circumstances do you use them? Were they successful? Tell me about the last time you used one of these
- On a scale of 0 (poor) to 10 (excellent), what grade would you give to this product? Why?
- How do you obtain solutions to those needs?
- Tell me about the last time you searched for a solution: where/how did you search and what happened?
- What do you wish you could do with these products that you can't do today?
- What could be done to improve this product?
- What's most appealing to you about this product?
- What might improve your experience using the product?
- What motivates you to continue using this product?
- What's the hardest part about using this product?
- What features do you wish the product had? Why?

5. The Fit Between Your Customer Profile & Your Value Proposition

Customer interviews are excellent opportunities to co-create with customers and check whether your value proposition addresses your customer's jobs, pains and gains.

- What would a ideal solution do to solve your problem? What would it look like?
- Based on what you described as the ideal solution, could you help me rank the features according to their importance to you?
- Can you walk me through the process of acquiring, using and disposing this solution?
- Why do you think this solution hasn't been created yet? If someone creates it, would there be hurdles to its adoption?
- What do you think could be done to help you with (pain/job)?
- What product do you wish you had that doesn't exist yet?
- How likely are you/would you be to tell your friends about this product?
- What would make you want to tell your friends about this product?
- Here is a set of 5 features: do you think they create value to you? how so? Can you rank them according to their importance to you?
- How would your (day, experience, task) be different if you could have (pain reliever/gain creator) ?
- Would a product that focuses on (pain reliever/gain creator) solve your problem? Why?

6. How Much Your Value Proposition's Pain Relievers & Gain Creators Matter to Customers

This one is critical. Your value proposition has to create substantial value and matter enough to customers that they'll make the effort of getting it and pay for it (if it's a paid product).

- On a scale of 0 (useless) to 10 (extremely useful), how important is (your pain reliever/gain creator) to you?
- What obstacles might prevent you from using this product that does (pain reliever/gain creator): cost, task, office/home politics, other products?
- Can you rank the features I've presented to you according to their importance to you?
- How much time / money are you willing to spend on a product that does (your pain reliever/gain creator)?